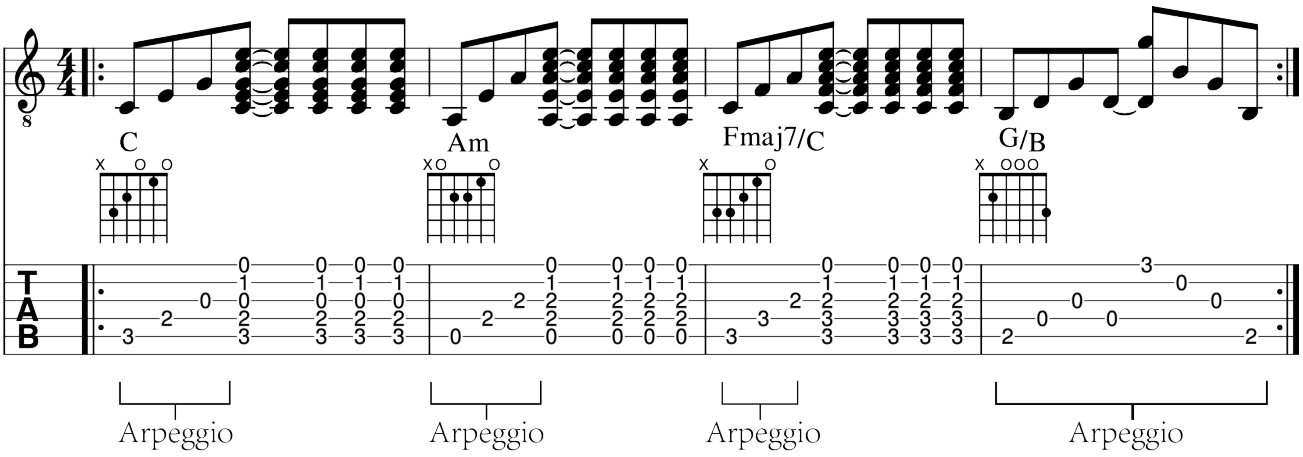
LESSON 16: ARPEGGIOS AND STRUMMING STYLES

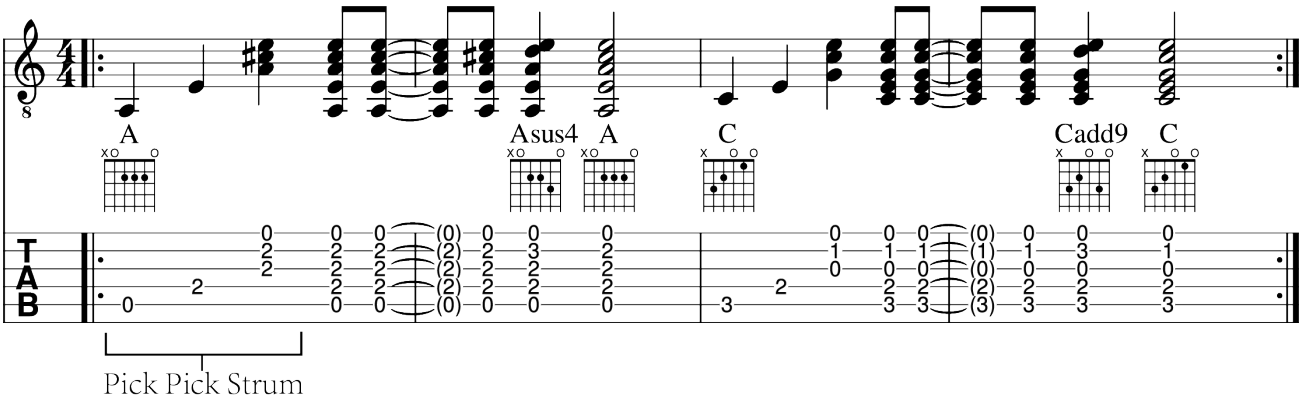
When we play the notes of a chord one-at-a-time (instead of all-at-once), it's called an **arpeggio**. Arpeggios are often blended with regular strums to create more engaging rhythm patterns, as demonstrated below.



The arpeggiated notes can be picked with all downstrokes, or with alternate picking. Additionally, the syncopated strum on the "and of 2" can be played with a downstrum for ease (instead of an up like it "should be").

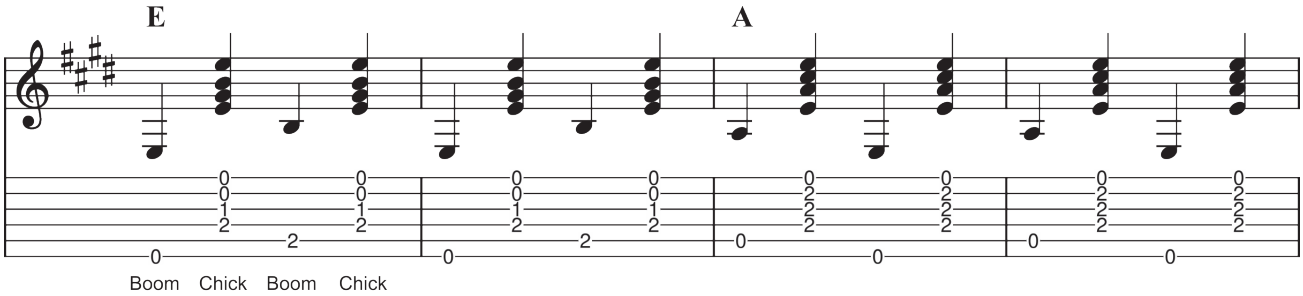
Pick - Pick - Strum

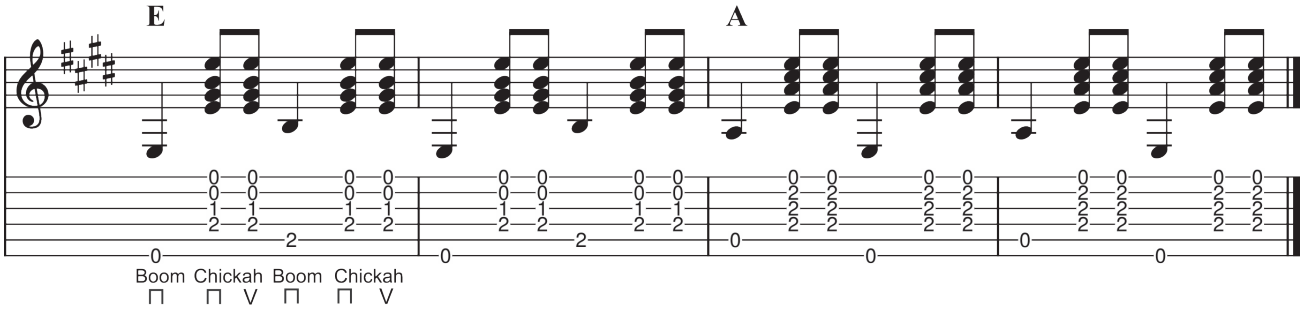
While not technically an arpeggio, it is common to hear the two lowest notes of the chord played individually before the remainder of the chord is strummed. Think "Pick Pick Strum" on every chord.

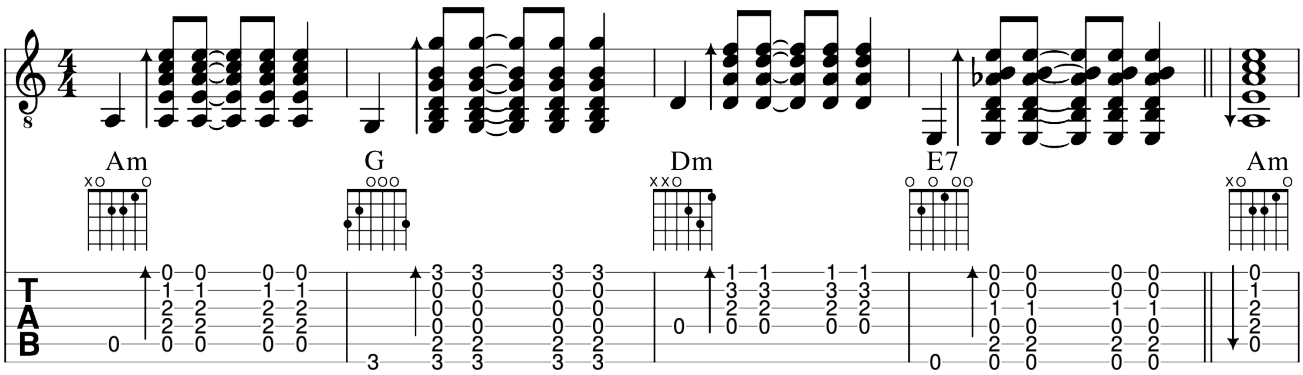


“Boom-Chick” Rhythms

A common occurrence in country and folk genres are “boom-chick” rhythms. You alternate between picking the low notes of a chord (usually the root and fifth), and in between you strum the chord’s high notes as shown below. Practice these rhythms with and without staccato timing and/or palm mutes. Perhaps you can hear — these rhythms got their name from the sound they create!





Arpeggiated Strums

By steeply angling your pick (upwards when strumming down, or downwards when strumming up), and dragging the pick firmly across the strings, you can create an “arpeggiated strum” or “rolled chord”. This serves as a nice embellishment for a chord’s first appearance, or a chord that ends a piece. Note that the last note of the strum should actually land on the beat, so this type of strum must begin slightly early!